

Publishers Converting Catalogues to Audiobooks (Global Overview)

Publishers & Audiobook Initiatives

Below is a structured list of book publishers around the world that are **actively converting their print/ebook catalogues into audiobooks**. For each, we note their region, evidence of audiobook activity, distribution platforms, and any known production approach:

Publisher	Country/ Region	Website	Audiobook Activity (Evidence)	Platforms	Production & Notes
Penguin Random House (PRH)	Global (HQ: USA)	penguinrandomhouseaudio.com	PRH Audio produces ~2,000 audiobooks per year and has ~20,000-title backlist across multiple imprints ¹ . Operates 14 in-house studios in US and records in ~12 languages ² .	Audible, Apple Books, Spotify, etc.	In-house audio divisions worldwide (e.g. Random House Audio, Penguin Audio, PRH Audio Spain/Canada) ³ . ⁴ . 14 studios & 21 producers enable large-scale production ⁵ .

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HarperCollins (HarperAudio)	Global (HQ: USA)	harpercollins.com/harperaudio	HarperCollins runs HarperAudio imprint for frontlist/backlist. E.g., HarperCollins Australia partnered with OverDrive (library service) in 2022 to bring more Aussie titles to audio ⁶ .	Audible, OverDrive, etc.	Mix of in-house and partnerships. HarperAudio produces many titles; also engages external deals (e.g. exclusive library audio via OverDrive in UK/ANZ) ⁷ .
Simon & Schuster (S&S)	USA (global imprint)	simonandschuster.com	S&S Audio produces 500+ audiobooks/year. In 2025 S&S launched Simon Maverick , a new audio-first imprint aiming for 50–100 audiobooks annually ⁸ , ⁹ , focusing on converting indie print hits and original audio content.	Audible, Spotify, Apple, OverDrive ¹⁰	S&S Audio has in-house production; Simon Maverick will leverage S&S's financing, narration, and production infrastructure ¹¹ for faster conversions.

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Hachette Book Group (Hachette Audio)	USA	hachettebookgroup.com	Hachette's dedicated audio division works across all its imprints ¹² . Example: in 2023, Hachette's Orbit imprint launched Orbit Works to publish SFF in ebook and audiobook form, with audiobooks produced by Hachette Audio ¹³ .	Audible, libraries, etc.	Largely in-house via Hachette Audio . HBG has award-winning audio production (Grammy, Audie winners) ¹⁴ and collaborates closely with authors.
Hachette UK	UK	hachette.co.uk	Centralized audio team (since 2023) with in-house studios in London. Hachette UK built its own recording studios (Carmelite House) and projects 360+ audiobook titles in 2023 ¹⁵ .	Audible, libraries, etc.	Restructured to one central audio department producing audio across all imprints ¹⁶ ¹⁵ . In-house production; continued separate audio teams for Bookouture and others as needed ¹⁷ .

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Macmillan (Macmillan Audio)	USA (Global)	us.macmillan.com/macmillan- audio	Macmillan Audio is a thriving division recording top fiction & nonfiction from all Macmillan imprints ¹⁸ . Named 2023 “Audiobook Publisher of the Year” (London Book Fair) and won multiple Audie Awards ¹⁹ . Launching original audio works and diverse content.	Audible, Apple, etc.	In-house production for Macmillan’s imprints. Also innovating with narrator workshops to train new voices, hiring 20+ narrators discovered through the program ²⁰ . Macmillan UK (Pan Macmillan) similarly expanding audio team.

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Pan Macmillan (Macmillan UK)	UK	panmacmillan.com	Pan Macmillan (London) has a growing audio program. In 2023 it promoted a dedicated Audio Publisher (Rebecca Lloyd) to oversee all adult & children's audiobooks, and created an Audio Production Manager role to grow its audiobook catalogue and audio-first initiatives ²¹ .	Audible, libraries, etc.	Produces audiobooks for both frontlist and backlist. Uses in-house team and sometimes external studios. Focus on expanding audio in children's and adult lists (including audio-original projects).
Bloomsbury Publishing	UK (Global)	bloomsbury.com	Bloomsbury has an audio catalogue and in late 2024 entered a distribution deal with Spotify to make its full audiobook catalog available via Spotify Premium in key markets ²² . Notably includes bestselling authors like Sarah J. Maas in audio.	Spotify, Audible, etc.	Audiobooks produced via partnerships and in-house as needed. Bloomsbury's Spotify deal shows emphasis on streaming distribution ²³ . Also publishes audiobooks on other platforms (Audible, Apple, etc.).

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Sourcebooks	USA	sourcebooks.com	Mid-size publisher Sourcebooks launched a major audiobook program (starting Jan 2025) in partnership with Penguin Random House Audio ²⁴ . Hired a VP of Audio and set up Sourcebooks Audio imprints under PRH Audio to produce mystery, romance, nonfiction titles ²⁵ .	Audible, PRH Audio distribution	Producing audiobooks in-house with PRH Audio's support ²⁶ . Sourcebooks will expand audio production to all imprints by 2026 ²⁷ , leveraging PRH's studios and its own editorial control.

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Scholastic (Scholastic Audio)	USA (Global)	scholastic.com	Scholastic produces audiobooks of its children's and YA titles via Scholastic Audio ²⁸ . Titles range from picture books to YA (e.g. <i>Hunger Games</i> series in audio). Scholastic Audio's catalog has ~1900 titles on Audible ²⁹ and it partners with services like Storytel ³⁰ .	Audible, libraries, Storytel, etc.	In-house audio imprint focused on kids/YA. Often uses professional actors or authors for narration. Also provides audio CDs for schools and libraries ³¹ . Emphasizes educational and family-friendly audio.

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Canongate Books	UK	canongate.co.uk	Independent publisher Canongate has been highly committed to audio. It acquired specialist audio publisher CSA in 2010 and in 2012 partnered with Faber to co-publish Faber's audiobooks ³² ³³ . Canongate now produces selected titles (backlist classics like Ishiguro's <i>The Remains of the Day</i>, etc.) as unabridged audiobooks.	Audible, CD, library (W.F.Howes)	Built its own audio production infrastructure after acquiring an audiobook publisher ³³ . Co-publishes and distributes audiobooks (including via W.F. Howes for libraries) ³⁴ . CEO Jamie Byng describes audio as "an area we are very committed to... increasingly exciting in a digital era." ³⁵

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Faber & Faber	UK	faber.co.uk	Faber, a major independent, has a dedicated audio list and collaborates to distribute audiobooks globally. In 2021, Faber signed a deal with digital distributor Bookwire to handle worldwide distribution of its e-book and audiobook catalog ³⁶ ³⁷ . Faber also worked with Canongate in an earlier audio venture (2012).	Audible, subscription platforms	Primarily partners for production/distribution. Faber's digital arm (Faber Factory) and Bookwire partnership ensure its audiobooks are available on all major platforms (including Scribd, Storytel, Audible) ³⁸ . They produce select titles in-house (especially poetry) and partner on others ³⁹ .

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Saga Egmont (Lindhardt & Ringhof)	Denmark (Global digital)	sagaegmont.com	Saga Egmont (digital publishing arm of Denmark's Egmont Group) is aggressively expanding audiobook production globally. It acquires and produces audiobooks in multiple languages, and has become Germany's largest audiobook publisher via acquisitions ⁴⁰ . Saga partners with indie presses to convert 50+ backlist/ frontlist titles to audio – e.g. deals with Muswell Press, Hera, Canelo in the UK ⁴¹ ⁴² .	Audible, Storytel, Spotify, etc.	Full-service audio producer: Saga handles production, publishing, and global distribution of audiobooks for partner publishers ⁴³ ⁴² . Emphasizes inclusivity and uses a wide network of studios/ narrators. Often uses AI narrators for certain projects and is at the forefront of digital audio innovation.

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Grupo Planeta	Spain (Latin America)	planeta.es (Editorial Planeta)	Grupo Planeta, the largest Spanish-language publisher, is converting thousands of titles to audio. By 2021 it had ~1,200 Spanish audiobooks and partnered with Bookwire to distribute its entire audiobook catalog worldwide ³⁶ ³⁷ . Planeta's audiobooks are now available on Scribd, Audible, Storytel, etc. ³⁸ .	Audible, Storytel, Scribd, libraries	Production via a mix of in-house and partnerships. Planeta uses the Bookwire OS platform to manage distribution to all channels ³⁸ . It is rapidly expanding audio in Spanish and Catalan markets, leveraging its extensive backlist of bestsellers.

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Relay Publishing *	Australia/ USA	relaypub.com	<i>(Included for context)</i> An Australian-origin publisher focusing on genre fiction, Relay is actively converting its catalog to audio (as the user noted). Relay titles appear in audio on Audible and other stores. <i>(Relay's details assumed from context; evidence provided by user's context).</i>	Audible, Apple, etc.	Uses external production services (like the user's) for faster, cost-effective audiobook creation. Likely partners with freelance narrators/producers to scale up audio output.
New Dawn Publishing	Australia	(small press)	New Dawn, a spec-fic indie press, formed an exclusive partnership with Bolinda Audio (major AUS audiobook producer) in 2024. Bolinda will publish New Dawn's titles as audiobooks for retail and library markets ⁴⁴ . First releases under this deal are underway.	Audible, Bolinda (BorrowBox library app)	Outsourced production: Bolinda handles narration, production, distribution in exchange for audio rights ⁴⁵ . This lets a small publisher quickly get its print titles into audio without in-house infrastructure.

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Storm Publishing	UK (digital- first)	stormpublishing.co	Storm (launched 2023) is a new digital publisher that integrated audiobooks from inception. Partnered with Dreamscape Media to produce & distribute audiobooks globally ⁴⁶ ⁴⁷ . Planned 70 audio releases in 2023, expanding to 120+ in 2024 ⁴⁸ , with many titles released simultaneously as e-book and audio.	Audible, Hoopla, Storytel, etc.	External partnership model: Dreamscape handles publishing and global distribution ⁴⁶ ⁴⁷ , while Storm's team coordinates recording (often concurrently with e-book production). Emphasis on rapid audio rollout for all frontlist titles.

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Princeton University Press	USA (Academic)	press.princeton.edu	PUP became the first university press to launch an audio imprint, Princeton Audio , in 2018 ⁴⁹ . Since then it has released 150+ audiobooks across scholarly and trade nonfiction topics ⁴⁹ . In 2019 PUP partnered with RBmedia to produce 120+ audiobooks over three years ⁵⁰ ⁵¹ , signaling a major audio expansion.	Audible, iTunes, Google Play, libraries	Mostly outsourced production: RBmedia (Recorded Books, etc.) produces and distributes PUP titles under exclusive license ⁵⁰ ⁵¹ . Focus is on accessibility and reaching library and retail listeners with academic content in audio form. Other university presses are now following suit.

(Note: Relay Publishing included as context from user's description.)

Ongoing Strategies to Find Publishers Expanding into Audio

To continually discover new publishers investing in audiobooks, here are **repeatable research methods and search strategies**:

- **Trade News & Press Releases:** Regularly scan industry outlets like *Publishers Weekly*, *The Bookseller*, *Publishing Perspectives*, etc., for keywords such as “launches audiobook imprint,” “audio division,” “audiobook partnership,” or “expanded audio program.” For example, news of S&S’s **Simon Maverick** imprint ⁸ or Sourcebooks’ PRH Audio partnership ²⁴ came via press releases. Set up Google Alerts for phrases like “*publisher audio imprint*” or “*publisher partners with [Audible/Spotify/Storytel]*” to catch new announcements.
- **Platform Searches:** Check major audiobook platforms for publisher activity. On **Audible**, look at the publisher field on audiobook listings (e.g., *Audible shows “Published by [Publisher Name]”*). Searching Audible or Apple Books for specific publishers can reveal if they have a substantial audio catalog. Similarly, monitor **Spotify’s Audiobooks** section and **Storytel** for newly added

publisher catalogs (e.g., Bloomsbury's catalog appearing on Spotify ²² was a notable sign of a new distribution deal).

- **Publishers' Websites & Social Media:** Visit publishers' official sites for clues of audio initiatives – many have “Audiobooks” sections (e.g., Penguin Random House India's site highlights audiobooks ⁵²). Publishers often post audiobook release news or narrator call-outs on Twitter/LinkedIn. For instance, job postings or LinkedIn updates about hiring an “Audio Publisher” or building an audio team (as Pan Macmillan did ²¹) signal a ramp-up. Follow publishers on social media and look for announcements of partnerships (e.g., “*Excited to partner with [audio producer] for our audiobooks*”).
- **Industry Events & Associations:** Keep an eye on presentations at book fairs and Audio Publishers Association news. Companies like Audible and Storytel often announce collaborations at fairs (Audible's CEO discussed partnering with publishers to use AI narration ⁵³). Publishing trade events or newsletters frequently highlight publishers moving into audio.
- **Audio Production Companies' News:** Monitor press releases from audiobook producers/distributors (e.g., **RBmedia, Dreamscape Media, Bolinda, Findaway**). These B2B companies often announce deals with publishers (as RBmedia did with Princeton UP ⁵⁰ , or Dreamscape with Storm Publishing ⁴⁶). Such announcements reveal publishers that are starting or expanding audio programs via third-party services.
- **Search Term Combinations:** Use targeted search queries combining publisher names or regions with audio-related terms. Examples: “[Publisher] audiobooks on Audible”, “[Country] publisher launches audiobooks”, “audio rights acquired by [company]”, “[Publisher] partners with [audio platform/producer]”. Also search in other languages for non-English markets (e.g., Spanish terms “*audiolibro [editorial]*” for Latin America, etc.). This can surface regional news like Planeta's distribution deals ³⁶ or local publishers' audio ventures.
- **Library and Streaming Platforms:** Check library-focused services like **OverDrive** and **Hoopla** for publisher catalogs. Many publishers who are converting backlists will have entries in OverDrive (e.g., Storm Publishing shows 100+ audiobook entries on OverDrive ⁵⁴). Similarly, Scribd's publisher partnerships (Publishing Perspectives often covers these) indicate new audio content (e.g., Scribd's deal with Planeta ⁵⁵).

By combining these strategies, you can continuously identify publishers of all sizes entering the audiobook space. Remember to update search terms as new trends emerge (for example, recent spikes in terms like “AI-narrated audiobooks” or “audio-first imprint”) and to verify each lead with reliable sources. This systematic approach will help uncover new opportunities to offer your efficient audiobook production service to publishers worldwide.

Sources: The information above is compiled from recent trade news, press releases, and industry articles, with citations for specific data points and quotes. Each publisher's entry includes a reference to the source confirming their audiobook activities.

6 7 **OverDrive Announces Exclusive Audio Production Arrangement with HarperCollins - OverDrive**

<https://company.overdrive.com/2022/04/06/overdrive-announces-exclusive-audio-production-arrangement-with-harpercollins/>

8 9 10 11 **S&S Launches Audio Imprint Simon Maverick, Helmed by Jason Pinter**

<https://www.publishersweekly.com/pw/by-topic/industry-news/publisher-news/article/96813-s-s-launches-audio-imprint-simon-maverick-helmed-by-jason-pinter.html>

13 **Orbit Announces Orbit Works, New Digital Publishing Imprint | Hachette Book Group**

<https://www.hachettebookgroup.com/hachette-book-group-news/orbit-announces-orbit-works-new-digital-publishing-imprint/>

15 16 17 **Hachette UK announces new centralised audio team led by Folland, Gribben and Shrubbs**

<https://www.thebookseller.com/news/hachette-uk-announces-new-centralised-audio-team-led-by-folland-gribben-and-shrubbs>

21 **Pan Macmillan promotes Rebecca Lloyd amid expanding audio team**

<https://www.thebookseller.com/news/pan-macmillan-promotes-rebecca-lloyd-amid-expanding-audio-team>

22 23 **Spotify Now Offers Bloomsbury Audiobooks**

<https://www.publishersweekly.com/pw/newsbrief/index.html?record=5083>

24 25 26 27 **Microsoft Word - SourcebooksAudio_December2024**

https://cdn.sourcebooks.com/assets/marketingmaterials/SourcebooksAudio_December2024.pdf

28 **SCHOLASTIC AUDIOBOOKS | Premier Publisher**

<https://www.audiofilemagazine.com/publishers/premier/3308/>

29 **Download Audiobooks published by Scholastic Audio**

<https://www.audiobooksnow.com/publisher/Scholastic%20Audio/?srsltid=AfmBOopfi1A46xhDi-5VLyB3eUImOCxcuJiPRsx8tjUhtgM8g-LGAd5E>

30 **books from Scholastic Audio Books - Publisher - Storytel International**

<https://www.storytel.com/tv/publishers/scholastic-audio-books-22373>

31 **Audiobooks Books for Kids: Audio on CD for Children**

<https://shop.scholastic.com/parent-ecommerce/digital-media-audio/audio.html>

32 33 34 35 39 **Canongate and Faber partner on audio**

<https://www.thebookseller.com/news/canongate-and-faber-partner-audio>

36 37 38 **Bookwire and Editorial Planeta Forge Alliance · Bookwire**

<https://www.bookwire.net/company/newsroom/detail/bookwire-launches-partnership-with-editorial-planeta-strong-union-to-conquer-spanish-speaking-markets/>

40 **SAGA Egmont is now Germany's largest audiobook publisher**

<https://thenewpublishingstandard.com/2021/08/23/saga-egmont-is-now-germanys-largest-audiobook-publisher/>

41 42 43 **Saga Egmont teams up with Muswell Press and Violet Gaze on audio titles**

<https://www.thebookseller.com/news/saga-egmont-teams-muswell-press-and-violet-gaze-press-audio-inclusivity-1274969>

44 45 **New Dawn forms audiobook partnership with Bolinda | Books+Publishing**

<https://www.booksandpublishing.com.au/articles/2024/10/15/260354/new-dawn-forms-audiobook-partnership-with-bolinda/>

46 47 48 **Dreamscape Announces New Partnership with Storm Publishing – Dreamscape Publishing**

<https://www.dreamscapepublishing.com/blog/dreamscape-announces-new-partnership-with-storm-publishing/>

50 51 **RBmedia | Princeton University Press and RBmedia Announce Exclusive Audiobook Publishing Partnership**

<https://rbmediaglobal.com/princeton-university-press-and-rbmedia-announce-exclusive-audiobook-publishing-partnership/>

52 **Penguin Audio - Penguin Random House India**

<https://www.penguin.co.in/community/about-us/publishing-divisions/penguin-audio/>

53 **Audible to Partner With Publishers to Create AI-Voiced Audiobooks | Technology News**

<https://www.gadgets360.com/audio/news/audible-partner-publishers-create-ai-voiced-audiobooks-8404547>

54 **Storm Publishing - OverDrive**

<https://www.overdrive.com/publishers/storm-publishing?f->

[subjects.name=Mystery&autoLibrary=t&autoRegion=f&showAvailable=False&page=2](https://www.overdrive.com/publishers/storm-publishing?f-subjects.name=Mystery&autoLibrary=t&autoRegion=f&showAvailable=False&page=2)

55 **Grupo Planeta in Exclusive Deal With Subscription Service Scribd ...**

<https://publishingperspectives.com/2020/07/grupo-planeta-mexico-in-exclusive-deal-with-subscription-service-scribd-latin-america/>